POSTCARD LANDING PAGES · WORK REPORT

Footer changes and the spam question

Three changes to the ten postcard landing pages, plus one decision that needs your answer before anything goes live.

Prepared **14 September 2026** Branch **main** Pages affected **10**

COMMITS READY	PUSHED TO ORIGIN	BUILT OUTPUT
2	Not yet	Stale

What changed

The Language Centre logo now matches the social icons

Your tweak, applied for real: the logo is 56 pixels tall and pulled up 8 pixels, so its circle lines up with the circles beside it. Because all ten pages draw their footer from one shared component, this was a single edit rather than ten. *Already pushed, in an earlier commit.*

The social icons were too small inside their circles

The marks grew from 16 pixels to 24 pixels inside the unchanged 36 pixel circles, which had been carrying more empty ring than icon.

A “preferred sources” link for Google

This lets a reader tell Google Search to show us more often in Top Stories and related results. Google offers two ways to do it — a JavaScript button, or a plain link. We used the plain link, which Google documents as the equivalent for sites that would rather not run the script. It sets no cookie and loads nothing, so it sits outside the cookie-consent machinery entirely and raises no data-protection question.

Enquiry emails now arrive with a subject line

The “Email us to book your appointment” and “Email the Study Centre” buttons used to open a blank message, so the inbox could not tell an advising booking from a Study Centre question. They now arrive titled **Language advising appointment** and **Study Centre enquiry**. Say the word if the inbox sorts on different wording.

The decision: should we hide the email addresses?

My recommendation is to leave them as plain, readable links — and to take the spam concern seriously somewhere it can actually be fixed.

The worry is that scrapers will harvest `enquiries@langcen.cam.ac.uk` from these pages. Three things argue against acting on it here:

- **The address is already published elsewhere on our own website.** The main Language Centre site lists it as plain text, alongside `culp@` and `adtis@`. Hiding it on ten postcard pages protects an address anyone can still collect from the main site in the same afternoon.
- **The usual tricks either don't work or cost us something real.** Encoding the address in the HTML is undone by any program that reads the page. Reversing it with styling defeats simple scrapers but corrupts what screen readers announce and what "copy email address" puts on the clipboard — an accessibility problem on a University site. Assembling it in JavaScript works against lazy bots, but means the contact route disappears entirely if the page's script fails to load.
- **Spam to a shared inbox is a mail-filtering problem.** That inbox receives mail prompted by the printed cards, the main website and the staff directory alike. Filtering in front of it addresses all of those; markup on ten pages addresses a fraction of one.

I looked for a general enquiries form to point the two buttons at instead, which would have sidestepped the question. There doesn't appear to be one — the Language Centre publishes addresses rather than a form. The only form I found is the specific conversation-exchange one, which isn't a general contact route. If a general form does exist, send me the address and I'll reconsider.

One point that settles it in favour of email: you asked whether a subject line could be filled in automatically. With an email link that is free and reliable — it's already done, as above. With a web form it only works if the form was built to accept it, which we can't assume and I couldn't verify.

If you'd still like something done, the honest next step is asking whoever runs the mail domain what filtering currently sits in front of that inbox.

Where the email address appears

An audit of every email link on the live pages. All twelve use the same correct address; none were broken or out of date.

LOCATION	APPEARS AS	REACH
Shared footer	the address itself	All 10 pages
Language advising	“Email us to book your appointment”	1 page
Visit our Study Centre	“Email the Study Centre”	1 page

The two buttons spell the address out rather than taking it from the shared setting, deliberately: they are each page's main way of getting in touch, and must keep working even if the page's script fails. That's now written down in the code beside the shared setting, naming both pages, so a future address change can't quietly miss them.

A further 22 links sit in the archived `old_files` folder, including pages we no longer publish. They aren't live and don't need changing — but worth knowing they're there, so a future find-and-replace doesn't trip over them.

Before this goes live

READY **Push the two commits**

They're committed and tested locally, but not yet sent to the repository.

READY **Rebuild the site**

The published files still hold the older footer. None of the above appears to visitors until they're rebuilt.

NEEDS CHECKING **Confirm we're eligible for preferred sources**

Google requires the site to appear in its source preferences tool, and the feature is aimed at news publishers. If we're not listed, the link still works but lands on a page that can't add us. Worth one visit to the link in the footer to see what happens.

YOUR CALL **Approve or change the email subject wording**

A one-line change each if the inbox expects different phrasing.

Prepared for the Language Centre postcard landing pages, branch `main`, 14 September 2026. Two commits await pushing; the built output needs regenerating before any of this reaches visitors.